

## Gigabyte GA-EP43-DS3L P45 mini edition...

The P43 is a new, and slightly cheaper variant of the high end P45 chipset. Gigabyte's offering is an all solid capacitor model (the *D* in the model name signifies this).

In terms of build quality this board is solid—no complaints. The layout is good.

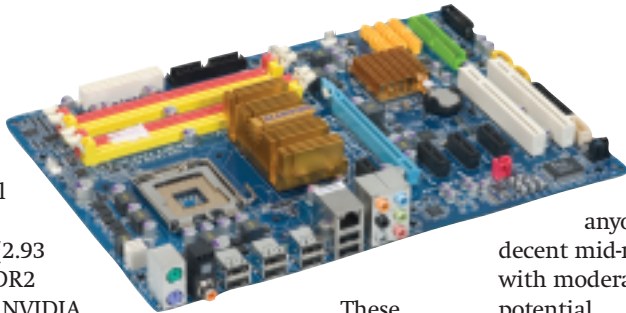
The BIOS itself is feature packed and well laid out, complete with overclocking options—although a surprise (and an irritation) was the lack of detailed information on the CPU model, and the memory installed.

On the rear I/O panel, it's interesting to note the presence of *eight* USB 2.0 ports—PS2 ports for mouse and keyboard are also provided.

We installed CoolerMasters Hyper 212 on this motherboard with absolutely no clearance issues, and there was quite a lot of room available. The CPU region features an eight phase design, and the

quality of mof-sets is top class. We used an Intel Core 2 Duo Extreme X6800 (2.93 GHz), 4 GB of DDR2 1066 MHz RAM, NVIDIA GeForce 8800GTX and a WD Raptor 80 GB 10,000 RPM drive to test this board.

|                           |         |
|---------------------------|---------|
| <b>PC Mark 05</b>         |         |
| CPU                       | 7538    |
| Memory                    | 5847    |
| Graphics                  | 13742   |
| HDD                       | 7118    |
| Overall                   | 8534    |
| 3D Mark 2005              |         |
| CPU Score                 | 17163   |
| CPU Score                 | 10650   |
| <b>SiSoft Sandra 2007</b> |         |
| CPU Dhrystone             | 27046   |
| CPU Whetstone             | 18754   |
| CPU Integer               | 161614  |
| CPU Floating              | 88038   |
| RAM Integer               | 5495    |
| RAM Floating              | 5490    |
| Drive Index               | 79 MBps |
| <b>Far Cry</b>            |         |
| 640 x 480                 | 134.55  |
| 1600 x 1200               | 150     |
| <b>DOOM 3</b>             |         |
| 640 x 480                 | 244.2   |
| 1600 x 1200               | 202.1   |



goodies into the higher-end chipsets. That being said this board is very suitable for anyone looking for a decent mid-range solution with moderate overclocking potential.

These scores are just about equivalent to a P45s scores, meaning the GA-EP43-DS3L is right there in terms of performance. We'd like to point out that the new PCIe 2.0 interface makes a slight difference in the gaming performance results, particularly at higher resolutions which is significant to gamers and overclockers who will use such benchmarks. At Rs 8,500, the GA-EP43-DS3L is a well laid out, and moderately feature-rich offering. The important thing is the price difference between this and the higher P45 chipset, as boards based on that chipset will have more features, or possibly greater overclocking potential, as manufacturers pump more

### Specifications

Northbridge—P43 chipset, Southbridge—ICH10, 16 GB DDR2 1200 MHz RAM support, all solid state capacitors, 1x PCIe x16 slot, 2x PCI slots, 3x PCIe x1 slots, 8x USB 2.0 ports, 7.1 channel Realtek ALC 888 audio solution.

Contact:  
Phone: 40633222  
E-mail: vivek@gigabyte.in  
Web site: www.gigabyte.in  
Price: Rs 8,500

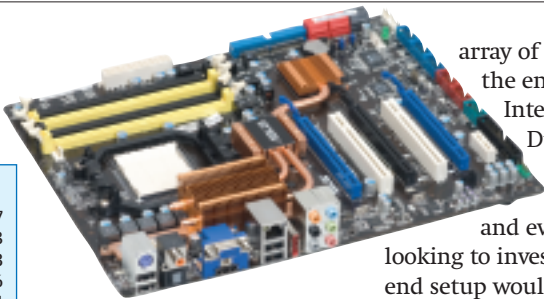
| RATINGS         |       |
|-----------------|-------|
| Features        | ★★★★☆ |
| Performance     | ★★★★☆ |
| Build quality   | ★★★★☆ |
| Value for Money | ★★★★☆ |
| Overall         | ★★★★☆ |

## ASUS M3N-HT Deluxe NVIDIA 780a SLI On A Rampage!

The 780a SLI is an NVIDIA chipset designed for AMD Phenom and Athlon CPUs. It is the first chipset to feature *Hybrid* SLI, which is sorely missed on all 780i and 790i boards. Hybrid SLI allows an integrated NVIDIA graphics chipset to work in tandem with an NVIDIA GeForce 9xxx series or newer card. This helps increment performance and save power.

ASUS' M3N-HT Deluxe is a beautiful board. The build quality is absolutely superb, and the beautiful heatpipe solution keeps things cool. The CPU region is quite clean, and the use of high quality solid state capacitors

|                             |        |
|-----------------------------|--------|
| <b>PC Mark 05</b>           |        |
| CPU                         | 5637   |
| Mem                         | 4208   |
| GPU                         | 11733  |
| HDD                         | 7216   |
| Overall                     | 7261   |
| 3D Mark 2005                |        |
| CPU                         | 14173  |
| CPU                         | 7904   |
| <b>DOOM 3</b>               |        |
| 640 x 480                   | 163.3  |
| 1600 x 1200                 | 159.5  |
| Far Cry                     |        |
| 640 x 480                   | 150    |
| 1280 x 1024                 | 152.2  |
| <b>SiSoft Sandra 2008</b>   |        |
| CPU Dhrystone               | 20102  |
| CPU Whetstone               | 11238  |
| CPU Multimedia Integer      | 122787 |
| CPU Multimedia Floating     | 70929  |
| Drive Index                 | 78     |
| Memory Bandwidth (Integer)  | 5156   |
| Memory Bandwidth (Floating) | 5147   |



array of features. At the end of the day, Intel's Core 2 Duos and Quads win the battle, and everybody

didn't escape us. The integrated graphics solution offers performance just below the GeForce 8400GS graphics card, and an HDMI port has also been provided—HD junkies take note. We tested this board with an AMD Phenom 8450 tri core CPU, 4 GB of DDR2 1066 MHz, WD Raptor 10,000 RPM HDD, and a GeForce 8800GTX.

At Rs 17,600 the M3N-HT Deluxe is uber costly, in fact a little too costly even for its

looking to invest in a high-end setup would go for an Intel solution. Only for AMD fan boys as of now.

Contact  
Phone: 67668800 / 18002090365  
E-mail: media\_india@asus.com  
Web site: www.asus.in  
Price: Rs 17,600

| RATINGS         |       |
|-----------------|-------|
| Features        | ★★★★☆ |
| Performance     | ★★★★☆ |
| Build Quality   | ★★★★☆ |
| Value for Money | ★★★★☆ |
| Overall         | ★★★★☆ |

## CoolerMaster Hyper 212 Cool Skyscraper

The last famous CPU cooler from CM was the Hyper 6, which was large and heavy. CM has now decided to go all out to claim the performance to price ratio throne with the Hyper 212. Its attractive, large, and is an all aluminium (except for the copper base) tower type heatsink. It comes with a CM 120mm blue LED fan already attached. Build quality is goo. The heatsink is huge, larger than Thermalright's

Ultra 120 Extreme. The Hyper 212 is, however, surprisingly light for its size. While assembling the cooler, we found an issue with the tiny screws supplied to mount the bracket of the retention front plate on to the cooler—one of these screws didn't fit properly. Its easier to install as compared to other tower-type coolers since the CPU retention plate bolts on to the heatsink and this prevents the screws

from falling off once you reverse the motherboard to tighten the backplate on.

The Hyper 212 is accommodated easily on even heatpipe based boards. The option to install a second fan in a push-pull, (one fan pushes air, the other fan pulls this pushed air through), is available. However a second fan isn't provided.

We tested it using a Core 2 Quad Extreme QX9650 (3.0 GHz), comparing it against Intel's stock cooler and Thermalrights Ultra 120.

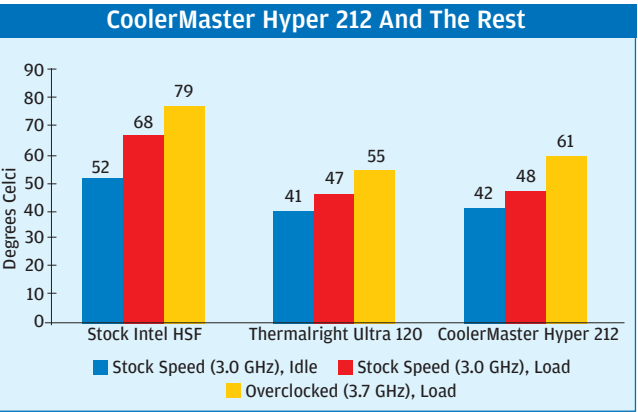
For loading the CPU we used WPrime. The results show great cooling at stock, although it loses ground on an overclocked setup. At Rs 2,250, its a well priced, great cooler for non hardcore overclockers, we wish it were less bulky, like the TR Ultima 90i.



### Specifications

Tower type cooler, aluminium with copper base, 120mm fixed fan

Contact  
Phone: 9833870302  
E-mail: Tanmay\_L@Coolermaster.com  
Web site: www.coolermaster.com  
Price: Rs 2,250



| RATINGS         |       |
|-----------------|-------|
| Features        | ★★★★☆ |
| Performance     | ★★★★☆ |
| Build Quality   | ★★★★☆ |
| Value for Money | ★★★★☆ |
| Overall         | ★★★★☆ |

## Aten ALTUSCN KE8220 Connectivity Galore

KVM solutions are pretty common, but this beauty is advertised as a *wireless presentation system*. The device is actually a multi-port KVM control unit that works on the basis of IP addresses. Just like regular KVM switches allow the user to juggle between two PCs desktops, the KE8220 allows the any PC/notebooks desktop environment to be transmitted to another PC/notebook or a display. It has WLAN (802.11 b/g) capabilities and that allows the user to make presentations without the need for switching cables. In terms of looks, the KE822 is a very simple, yet attractive looking device, housed in a

rugged metal shell, finished in all black. It looks like a miniature network hub sans all the ports. There's also a rack mount bracket provided. The best part of the inbuilt WiFi is that for use with notebooks and other such WLAN enabled devices no external access point is required. The KE8220 embedded Web server has software installed on it which users connecting to its network wirelessly can download. The software allows switching the display focus between computers—an enormous boon in case multiple people are giving presentations.



At the rear of the product you'll find an RJ45 connect for an Internet/LAN connection, and for WLAN purposes there's a single USB type A connect. There's one each of keyboard, mouse and monitor (D-Sub) connects. Note that both keyboard and mouse connects are USB based, so PS2 port based keyboards and mice are out.

We tested this device and used it to stream PowerPoint presentations and video files to our 32 inch Vu LCD screen, from one desktop PC, and two notebooks. The KE8220 works really well,

except that with four wireless clients connected we feel speed could become an issue. Maybe once 802.11n specification becomes standard we'll see a WiFi N version of this product. At Rs 22,500, this an IT concious business houses' dream tool—ease and flexibility of use.

### Specifications

WLAN based on 802.11b/g, Video connect—D-Sub, Wired LAN connect—RJ45

Contact  
Phone: 022 -25008962  
E-mail: marketing@cubixindia.com  
Web site: www.cubixindia.com  
Price: Rs 22,500

| RATINGS         |       |
|-----------------|-------|
| Features        | ★★★★☆ |
| Performance     | ★★★★☆ |
| Build Quality   | ★★★★☆ |
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